STUDENT CAPSTONE PROJECT

AI Digital Marketing Plan for a Local Business

Bento Cafe | Chengalpattu

Student name	_____
Course / department	_____
Mentor / coordinator	_____
Submission date	_____

Prepared as a practical marketing-plan project. Confirm the cafe details with the owner or from reliable public information before final submission.

Project Snapshot

This project proposes a low-cost, AI-assisted digital marketing plan for a small local cafe called Bento Cafe in Chengalpattu. The plan focuses on helping nearby people discover the cafe, understand its menu, and make enquiries or visits. The business details below are working assumptions until verified.

Important: This is a project draft. Replace assumptions with facts you confirm. Do not claim that a campaign increased sales unless you actually ran it and measured the result.

1. Business Profile

Item	Details to confirm / current working assumption
Business name	Bento Cafe (confirm its correct public name)
Location	Chengalpattu, Tamil Nadu (add area / landmark after confirming)
Products	Assumption: bento-style meals and cafe drinks. Confirm the real menu and prices.
Customer groups	Possible groups: students, nearby workers, families, and local residents. Verify through observation or a short conversation.
Current online presence	Check whether it has Instagram, WhatsApp Business, Google Business Profile, or delivery listings. Record links only if verified.

2. Problem Statement

Small cafes may find it difficult to post consistently, show clear menu information, and reach nearby customers with a limited marketing budget. For this project, investigate which of these challenges applies to Bento Cafe. The confirmed problem should be written here: _____.

3. Project Objectives

• Prepare a simple, affordable digital marketing plan suitable for a small cafe.
• Use AI to assist with content ideas, captions, and a posting schedule, then review and edit all outputs.
• Make it easier for local customers to discover the menu and contact or visit the cafe.
• Recommend basic measures the business can track each week.

4. Target Audience

Primary audience (working assumption): people who live, study, or work near the cafe in Chengalpattu and want a convenient meal or drink. Needs to validate: preferred items, typical visit times, budget range, and how they find local cafes. A short, voluntary conversation with the owner or a few customers can help; do not collect private or sensitive information.

5. Marketing Goals

For a first four-week pilot, track these goals against a baseline rather than promising guaranteed growth:

Goal	How to track
Improve local discovery	Weekly reach and profile visits on the chosen social channel; Google profile views if available.

Goal	How to track
Encourage enquiries	Number of menu, location, or availability enquiries received through the chosen contact channel.
Encourage visits	Ask customers how they heard about the cafe, or use a simple campaign code. Record totals only.

6. Recommended Digital Marketing Plan

Instagram or Facebook: share clear food photos, menu highlights, short preparation clips, customer-approved testimonials, and offers with accurate terms. Choose the platform the cafe already uses or where local customers are active.

WhatsApp Business: if the owner agrees and can manage it, provide a current menu, opening hours, location, and a clear way to ask questions. Send promotions only to people who have agreed to receive them.

Google Business Profile: if the cafe has an eligible listing, keep its hours, location, contact details, menu link, and photos accurate. Ask customers for honest reviews without pressuring them or offering rewards for positive reviews.

Content approach: use authentic photos and verified prices. Include the cafe location, a simple call to action, and relevant local wording. Avoid making health, ingredient, or discount claims unless the owner confirms them.

7. How AI Will Be Used

AI can support the planning work by generating caption drafts, suggesting post themes, organizing a content calendar, and adapting wording for different audiences. The student should provide only non-sensitive business information, review every suggestion for accuracy and tone, and get owner approval before publishing. AI-generated facts, prices, photos, reviews, or performance results must not be presented as real.

Example prompt: “Suggest three friendly Instagram caption drafts for a small cafe in Chengalpattu. Use only these confirmed facts: [insert facts]. Do not invent prices, ingredients, offers, or opening hours. Keep each caption short and include a gentle invitation to visit.”

Record the AI tool and date used: _____

8. Sample Social Posts

Post 1 - Menu highlight: “Looking for a tasty meal nearby? Explore the Bento Cafe menu in Chengalpattu. Message us to check today’s available options. [Add verified menu link or contact details.]”

Post 2 - Behind the scenes: “A little look at how we prepare for the day at Bento Cafe. Visit us in [confirmed area], Chengalpattu. [Add owner-approved photo/video.]”

Post 3 - Customer invitation: “Your next local cafe stop could be here. Save this post and come by Bento Cafe in [confirmed area]. Check our profile for current hours and menu.”

These are drafts. Replace bracketed text and confirm all details before use.

9. One-Week Content Calendar

Day	Channel / format	Content idea	Purpose
Monday	Instagram story	Share confirmed opening hours and a menu item	Useful information
Wednesday	Photo post	Highlight one verified menu item; include price only if confirmed	Menu awareness
Friday	Short video / reel	Show an owner-approved preparation or cafe moment	Local discovery
Sunday	Story / WhatsApp status	Share next week’s confirmed timings or a customer FAQ	Enquiries and visits

10. Measurement and Review

Before the pilot, write down the current weekly numbers where available. Review them once a week for four weeks. Track post reach, profile visits, enquiries, and customer-reported visits. Compare totals with the baseline, note which content was posted, and discuss results with the owner. These measures show activity and interest; they do not prove that marketing alone caused a sales change.

Weekly tracking sheet (copy into a spreadsheet or CSV)

Week	Posts	Reach	Profile visits	Enquiries	Visits mentioning post
Baseline	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Week 1	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Week 2	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Week 3	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
Week 4	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

11. Privacy, Accuracy, and Ethics

Use public information or obtain permission before gathering business details. Do not publish customer faces, names, messages, or contact details without permission. Do not upload customer data to AI tools. Check that menu details, prices, location, and offers are current and owner-approved. Make it clear when an image is illustrative or AI-generated.

12. Conclusion

This plan gives Bento Cafe a manageable way to share useful, accurate content and make its online information easier for nearby people to find. AI can reduce the time needed to brainstorm and draft content, while the owner and student remain responsible for checking facts, approving posts, and reviewing results.

13. GitHub Repository and Submission

Create a repository such as ai-digital-marketing-plan-bento-cafe. Include this final report, a README file, the content calendar, sample posts, and a sources file. Add the public repository URL here after creating it: _____. The course announcement asks students to submit the report through the Google Drive link shared by coordinators and include the GitHub repository link. Confirm any extra format requirements with your mentor.

Suggested repository files

README.md - project overview and how to navigate the files
report.pdf - final report
content-calendar.csv - planned posts and goals
sample-posts.md - reviewed sample captions
sources.md - links and references
assets/ - only original or permission-cleared images

14. Sources and Research Notes

List every source used, including the cafe's official public pages, any interview or observation (with date and permission where relevant), and guidance used for the marketing plan. Do not list a source you did not actually consult.

Source 1: _____

Source 2: _____

Source 3: _____

Before submitting: verify cafe facts; replace assumptions; fill in student and mentor details; add your GitHub URL; check the course submission instructions.